



Student Perceptions of Learning Survey Course Report

FS24-PPL-805-001 (LEC) Microeconomic Theory

(Tyler Powell)

Project Title: **FS24 Student Perceptions of Learning Survey**

Courses Audience: **11**

Responses Received: **9**

Response Ratio: **81.82%**

Report Comments

Transition from SIRS to SPLS

Implementation of the Student Perceptions of Learning Survey (SPLS) began with courses ending June 16, 2023 and later. SIRS was administered in courses ending prior to June 16. More information about the transition from SIRS to SPLS and a complete copy of the recently revised university policy is available at spls.msu.edu.

Institution-Level Questions

Responses to seven institution-level questions are presented in this report, which are gathered from all students in all courses every term. Responses to some or all of the first six questions can be used in conjunction with other instructional review data to support course improvement and to inform annual reviews and personnel decisions such as retention, promotion, salary, and tenure. Other forms of instructional review can include classroom visits, peer review, teaching portfolios, reflections, and course material. Importantly, responses to the institution-level questions represent students' perceptions of their experiences in a course, not "evaluations of teaching" or measures of student learning.

Responses to four questions will be made available to students to guide decision-making related to course selection: Expectations, Organization, Atmosphere, and Workload. SPLS responses from multiple terms will be compiled before information is made available to students, which will not take place before 2025.

College and/or Department or School Questions

Responses to college and/or department or school questions are presented after the institution-level questions. Not all colleges and departments or schools have opted to include questions in the SPLS yet; some may administer an equivalent survey by other means (e.g., Qualtrics, FileMaker). Questions or concerns about college and/or department or school survey questions should be directed to the school, department, or college.

Open-Ended Questions

Research on student perceptions surveys cautions against open-ended questions, in part, because they offer the greatest opportunity for bias. The SPLE Policy does not prevent colleges or departments from using open-ended questions. Those who choose to use them are strongly encouraged to also draft a protocol for managing rude responses and ensure that they understand what the literature says about open-ended questions. Responses to open-ended questions are included in instructor reports, but they are not included in college or department reports or dashboards.

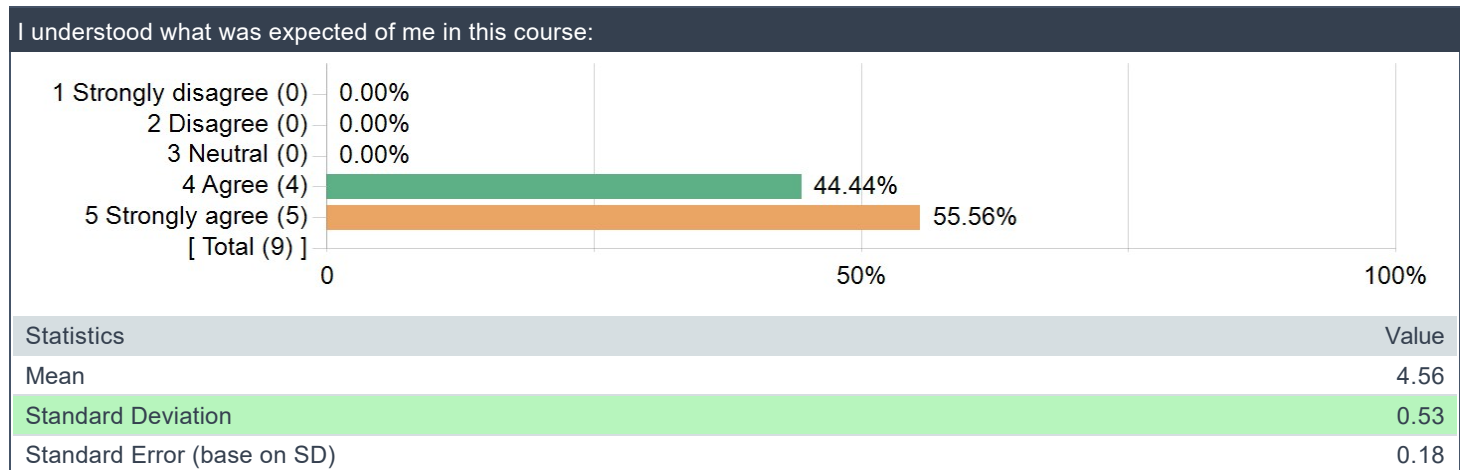
Variable Survey Periods

Variable survey periods were implemented starting in the spring 2024 term, which can contribute to higher response rates when paired with other strategies (e.g., reserve time in class, provide direct access via URL or QR code, describe how the instructor uses student feedback to improve the course).

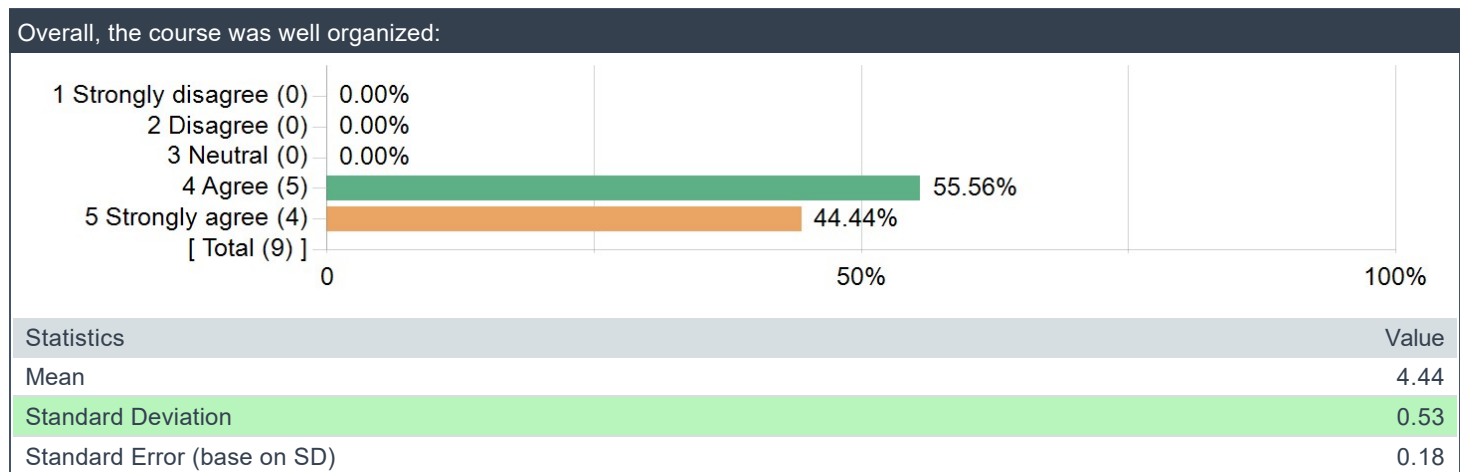
Course Duration	Survey Period
<6 weeks	5 calendar days
6 weeks to <11 weeks	7 calendar days
11 weeks or more	10 calendar days

Creation Date: **Sunday, December 15, 2024**

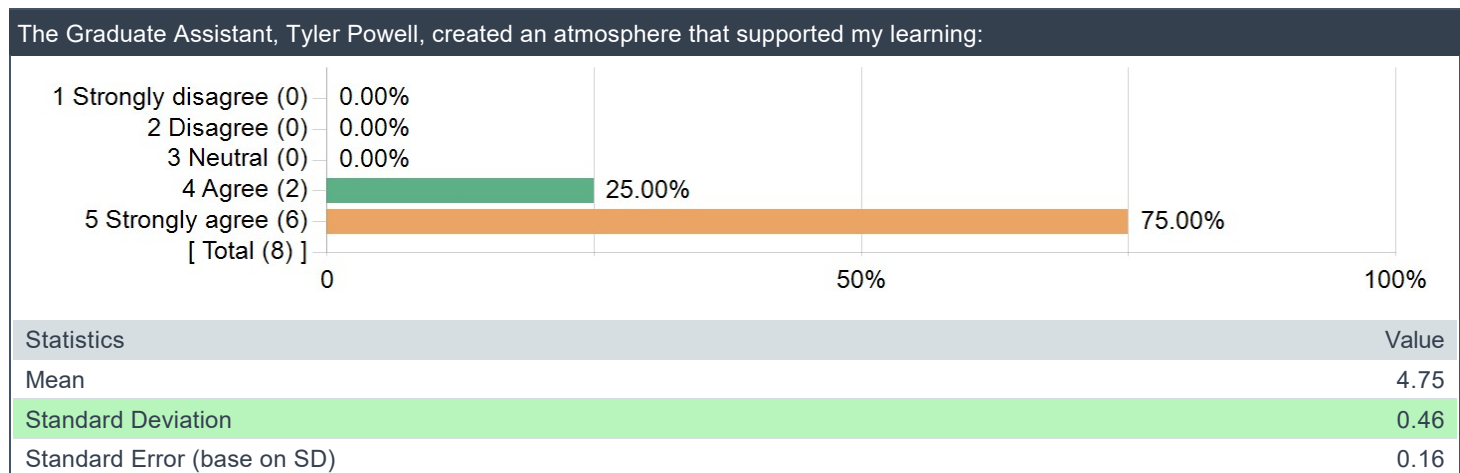
Expectations



Organization

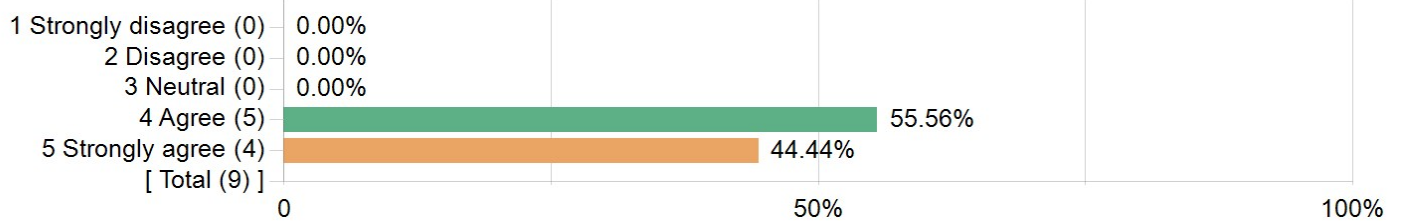


Atmosphere



Expanded understanding

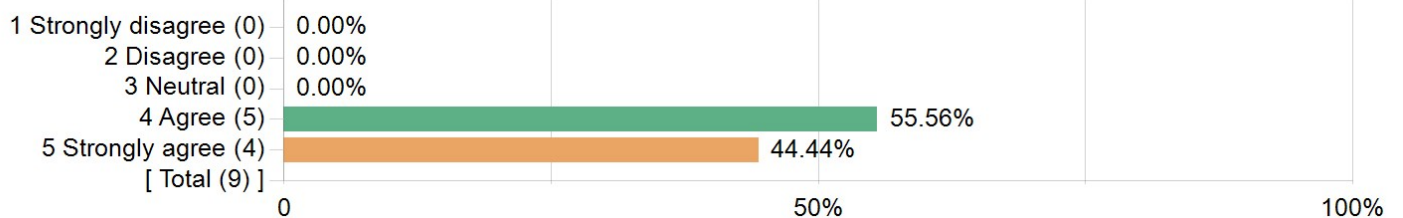
The course expanded my understanding of the subject matter:



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.44
Standard Deviation	0.53
Standard Error (base on SD)	0.18

Demonstrate understanding

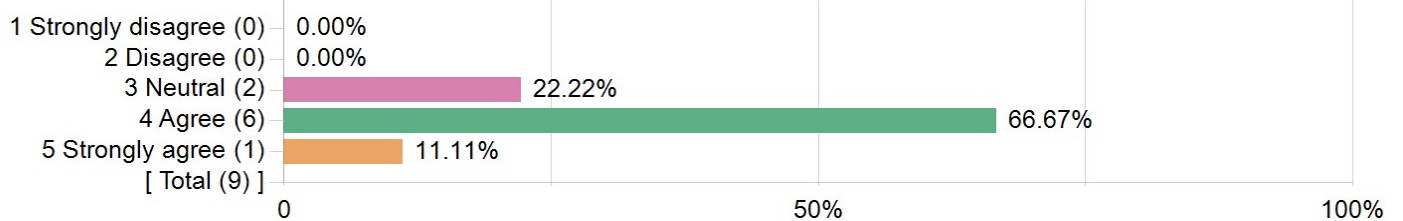
Course assignments and/or tests provided opportunities for me to demonstrate an understanding of the course material:



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.44
Standard Deviation	0.53
Standard Error (base on SD)	0.18

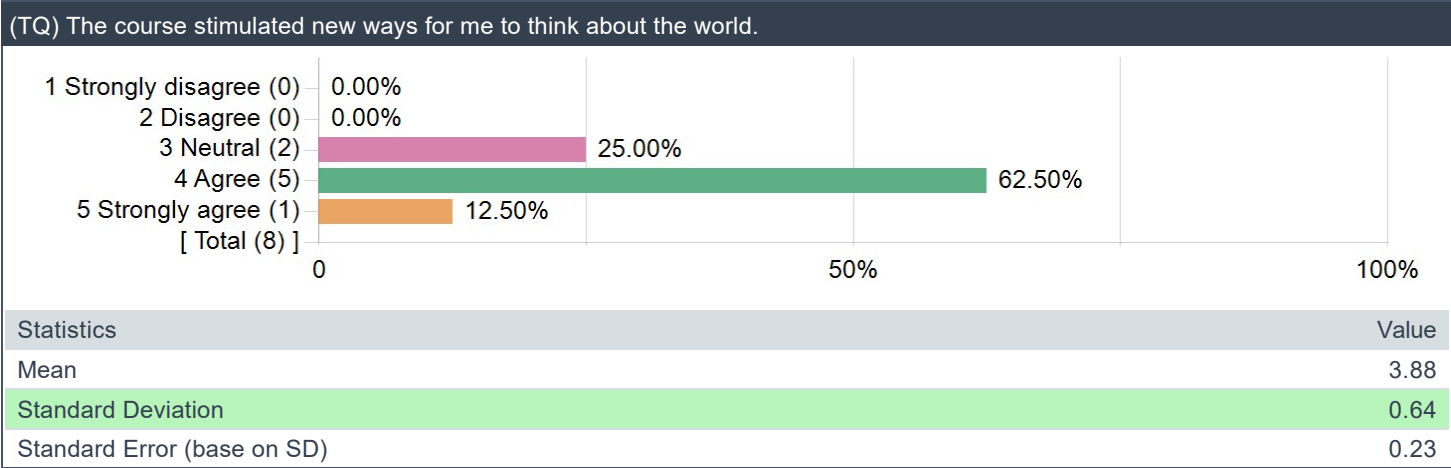
Interest increased

My interest in the subject has increased because of this course:



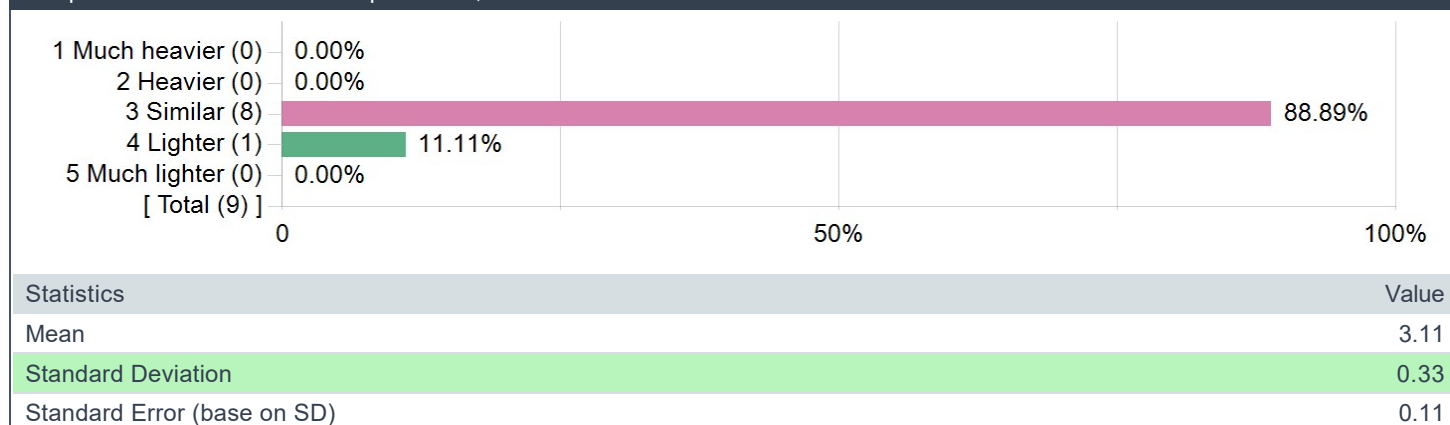
Statistics	Value
Mean	3.89
Standard Deviation	0.60
Standard Error (base on SD)	0.20

Dept/College Question (TQ55C)



Workload

Compared to other courses of equal credit, the workload for this course was:



Dept/College Question (TQ48C)

(TQ) What specific things about the course helped support your learning?

Comments

Detailed explanations of all the materials and willingness to always elaborate on it by Professor Powell.

The instructor was great at breaking down complex information and helped guide me to the understanding needed.

The problem sets and discussions/feedback about the final paper.

The lecturers, problem sets and class slides (notes)

Powerpoints and class discussion

I really enjoyed the project that we worked on in this course. Having the paper broken down into sections where we got feedback on each section really helped me.

Dept/College Question (TQ49C)

(TQ) What specific things about the course could be improved to better support student learning?

Comments

I would suggest less lecture heavy and more discussion based with real world application

Providing more material from real world applications of the theory studied in class. Maybe dedicating a small portion of class time to discussing these applications.

Introduce more policy application lecturers/problems as examples

In a policy-focused course, I feel like things could benefit from a bit more real-world application. The theory we discuss is helpful conceptually, but often feels disconnected from how things work in actuality. The basic economic models, I feel, fail to capture the complexity of policy, so ways of tying those things together would be helpful for me.

I do think that the presentations for each class could be a bit more condensed in a way that didn't lose interest as fast. A three-hour class is super hard to work with and the time itself makes it a hard class in general to present for. I think having it be more interactive or have in-class time to work on problem sets or in-class practice could really help!